SPaG: Year 6 Grammar Terms

Subject and object, active and passive, punctuation, synonyms and antonyms, ellipsis and more.

Name _____ Date _____ Class _____

Learning objective: I can identify and use Year 6 grammar terms correctly.
Terms follow the statutory national curriculum glossary (English Appendix 2).

1 Match the term

Draw a line from each grammar term to its meaning.

subject ●	● **A** A word that means the opposite of another word.
object ●	● **B** The noun, pronoun or noun phrase that names who or what is doing or being the verb.
passive ●	● **C** Leaving out a word or phrase because the reader can easily work out what is missing.
synonym ●	● **D** The noun, pronoun or noun phrase that the verb acts on. It usually comes straight after the verb.
antonym ●	● **E** A word that means the same, or nearly the same, as another word.
ellipsis ●	● **F** A sentence where the subject has the action done to it, e.g. *The cake was eaten.*

2 Subject and object

Underline the subject and **circle** the object in each sentence.

1. The goalkeeper caught the ball.
2. My grandma bakes delicious bread every Sunday.
3. After lunch, the children planted sunflowers.
4. Ravi's older sister painted a huge mural.

3 Active or passive?

Tick one box for each sentence.

	ACTIVE	PASSIVE
1 Mia opened the heavy door.	☐	☐
2 The cake was eaten by the twins.	☐	☐
3 The window was broken during the storm.	☐	☐
4 Our class planted three trees.	☐	☐

Remember: in a passive sentence, the person or thing that does the action can be added with *by* (*by the twins*) or left out completely (*The window was broken*). Passive verbs are useful in formal writing such as reports.
Challenge: say sentence 2 in the active voice.

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4 Make it passive

Rewrite each sentence in the passive voice. Keep the same meaning.

1 The dog chased the postman.

2 The class wrote a letter to the mayor.

3 A storm damaged the old bridge.

5 Colons and semi-colons

Add the punctuation shown in brackets in the correct place.

1 Pack these items for the trip a coat, a torch and a water bottle. *(add a colon)*

2 The museum was closed we went to the park instead. *(add a semi-colon)*

3 On our tour we visited Cardiff, Wales Belfast, Northern Ireland and Glasgow, Scotland. *(add two semi-colons)*

6 Hyphens

Hyphens can stop a sentence being ambiguous (having two meanings).

Explain the difference in meaning:
a man-eating shark and **a man eating shark**

Tick the sentence that means *put a new cover on* the armchair.

☐ We need to recover the old armchair.

☐ We need to re-cover the old armchair.

7 Synonyms and antonyms

a) Write a **synonym** for *enormous*.

b) Write an **antonym** for *generous*.

c) Circle the **antonym** of *ancient*.

old | modern | historic | ruined

d) Circle the **synonym** of *brave*.

fearful | calm | courageous | timid

8 Ellipsis and formal language

a Cross out the words that can be left out using **ellipsis**:
I wanted to go to the cinema, but my brother didn't want to go to the cinema.

b Circle the correct word to complete this formal sentence (the **subjunctive** form):
If I (was) (were) *the headteacher, I would make lunchtime longer.*

c Add a **question tag** to finish the sentence:
You have finished your homework, _____ ?

Answer Key

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Question	Answers
1 Match the term	subject → **B**; object → **D**; passive → **F**; synonym → **E**; antonym → **A**; ellipsis → **C**
2 Subject and object	1. subject: The goalkeeper · object: **the ball** 2. subject: My grandma · object: **delicious bread** 3. subject: the children · object: **sunflowers** 4. subject: Ravi's older sister · object: **a huge mural** Accept the head noun alone (e.g. *goalkeeper*, *grandma*, *sister*, *ball*, *bread*, *mural*). In 3, *After lunch* is a fronted adverbial, not the subject.
3 Active or passive?	1 active; 2 passive; 3 passive; 4 active Challenge: **The twins ate the cake.**
4 Make it passive	1. The postman was chased by the dog. 2. A letter was written to the mayor by the class. (Also accept: A letter to the mayor was written by the class.) 3. The old bridge was damaged by a storm.
5 Colons and semi-colons	1. Pack these items for the trip: a coat, a torch and a water bottle. 2. The museum was closed; we went to the park instead. 3. On our tour we visited Cardiff, Wales; Belfast, Northern Ireland; and Glasgow, Scotland. In 2, a colon or a dash between the two independent clauses is also correct, but the task asks for a semi-colon.
6 Hyphens	**a man-eating shark** is a shark that eats people; **a man eating shark** is a man who is eating shark meat. Tick: **We need to re-cover the old armchair.** (*recover* means get it back, or get better.)
7 Synonyms and antonyms	a) e.g. huge, gigantic, massive, immense, vast b) e.g. mean, selfish, stingy, miserly c) **modern** d) **courageous**
8 Ellipsis and formal language	a) Cross out *want to go to the cinema* → "…but my brother didn't." (Also accept crossing out only *go to the cinema* → "…didn't want to.") b) **were** c) **haven't you**